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DEFORMABLE VERTICAL PHOTOVOLTAIC SYSTEM AND METHOD FOR INSTALLING SUCH A SYSTEM

Abstract

The invention relates to a deformable vertical photovoltaic system (**100**) comprising at least one photovoltaic cell (**105**) and a post (**110**) having an axis (A), which deformable vertical photovoltaic system also comprises at least: a first attachment means (**115**), referred to as the “lower attachment means”, for attaching a lower portion of a module to a post; and a second attachment means (**120**), referred to as the “upper attachment means”, for attaching an upper portion of a module to a post, each means being at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post and/or at least free to rotate on an axis (B, C) perpendicular to the axis of the post, at least one attachment means from between the lower attachment means and the upper attachment means being at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post and the other attachment means being at least free to rotate on the axis perpendicular to the axis of the post.

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD OF THE INVENTION

[0001] The present invention relates to a deformable vertical photovoltaic system and a method for installing such a system. It applies, in particular, to the field of the production of energy from renewable sources.

STATE OF THE ART

[0002] In the field of the production of energy from renewable sources, the use of photovoltaic systems is an effective solution for transforming light energy into electrical energy. However, the installation of such systems must take certain constraints inherent in the installation site into account. These constraints can be mechanical and occur during the operation of photovoltaic systems. For example, exposure to the wind exerts significant dynamical mechanical stresses applied to the photovoltaic system. Ultimately, these mechanical stresses result, for example, in:

[0003] the formation of micro-cracks, frequently followed by an irreversible deterioration of the photovoltaic cells, which can occur with no change to the front and back protective covers of the module; and/or [0004] a mechanical deterioration of the front and back protective glass of the modules. This degradation of the modules results in a reduction in the electricity production. In particular, when this degradation occurs on one module, the reduction in the electricity production occurs on all the other modules serially connected to the degraded module. In addition, this degradation also results in the creation of “hot points” in the broken cells of the modules. These hot points accelerate the degradation of the module by damaging, in particular, an outer protective layer of the module. Damage to the outer protective layer of the module results, for example, in a current leakage and there a significant risk to the safety of the installation. In these cases, the local or total shutdown of the installation is necessary in order to change the degraded module. Thus, a premature ageing of the photovoltaic system occurs when such a system is subjected to dynamic mechanical stresses.

[0005] The solutions of the prior art describe the addition additional material to the photovoltaic system so as to strengthen and stiffen the supporting structure.

[0006] However, such solutions results in an increase in the production costs of the supporting structure, and also negative environmental impacts. Thus, the environmental impact of the life cycle of such structure is significantly affected. In addition, such an addition of material can result in more shadows on the photovoltaic modules, and therefore have a negative impact on the electricity production.

Presentation of the Invention

[0007] The present invention aims to remedy all or part of these drawbacks.

[0008] To this end, according to a first aspect, the present invention envisages a deformable vertical photovoltaic system comprising at least: [0009] a photovoltaic module having a front face, referred to as the “principal surface” of the module, parallel to the plane formed by the active parts of the photovoltaic cells; and [0010] a post having an axis (A), [0011] which deformable vertical photovoltaic system also comprises at least: [0012] a first attachment means, referred to as the “lower attachment means”, for attaching a lower portion of a module to a post; and [0013] a second attachment means, referred to as the “upper attachment means”, for attaching an upper portion of said module to said post, [0014] each attachment means being deformable and/or at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post and/or at least free to rotate on an axis perpendicular

to the axis of the post and parallel to the principal surface of the module, [0015] at least one attachment means from amongst the lower attachment means and the upper attachment means being deformable and/or at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post, and the other attachment means being deformable and/or at least free to rotate on the axis perpendicular to the axis of the post and parallel to the principal surface of the module.

[0016] Thanks to these provisions, the system enables a significant limitation of the dynamic mechanical stresses, for example, exerted on the module when the system is exposed to strong winds. When the module and/or the post are deformed under the action of dynamic mechanical stresses, the stresses at the location of the attachment means are minimised. In this way, the mechanical durability of the module is increased.

[0017] The mechanical deformation of the supporting structure of the system and the possibilities for movement of the attachment systems make it possible to limit the amount of material in this structure. The production of such a structure therefore requires a smaller amount of material enabling, for example, a reduction in the costs and environmental impacts inherent in the production. In addition, limiting the amount of material in the supporting structure of the system also allows the cross-section of elements of the system to be reduced. Therefore, the electricity production of the system is increased since the shadows formed by the structure and projected onto the photovoltaic module are minimised.

[0018] In addition, such a photovoltaic system can be installed easily, rapidly and possibly carried out on a large number of installation grounds comprising, for example, slopes or used for agriculture. The attachment means are compatible with a considerable variety of photovoltaic modules, such as modules having a large size, a non-standard organisation of the strings of photovoltaic cells, modules with or without frames.

[0019] Lastly, replacing a module, for example a damaged one, is facilitated without utilising complex means. In addition, the photovoltaic system can be disassembled easily and quickly. Therefore, the installation ground is not negatively impacted by an installation followed by removal when the operation of the photovoltaic system ceases.

[0020] In some optional embodiments, each attachment means is at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post and/or at least free to rotate on the axis perpendicular to the axis of the post and parallel to the principal surface of the module, at least one attachment means from amongst the lower attachment means and the upper attachment means being at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post and the other attachment means being at least free to rotate on the axis perpendicular to the axis of the post and parallel to the principal surface of the module. In some optional embodiments, one of the attachment means from amongst the lower attachment means and the upper attachment means is at least free to rotate on the axis perpendicular to the axis of the post and the other attachment means is at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post and at least free to rotate on the axis perpendicular to the axis of the post and parallel to the principal surface of the module.

[0021] Thanks to these provisions, when the photovoltaic system is subjected to dynamic mechanical stresses, the means for attaching to the post will rotate on two parallel axes. The significant mechanical tensions in the attachment area are therefore limited because the pinching effects are reduced. The cells of the photovoltaic module that are close to the attachment area are therefore preserved.

[0022] In some optional embodiments, one of the elements from amongst a rotationally free attachment means and the post comprises a hole and the other a shaft, the hole and the shaft forming a pivot link or a sliding pivot.

[0023] Thanks to these provisions, the system makes it possible for the module to rotate at the location of the pivot link or sliding pivot when dynamic stresses are applied.

[0024] In some optional embodiments, one of the elements from amongst a translationally free attachment means and the post comprises a slide channel and the other a slide, the slide channel

and the slide forming a sliding link or a sliding pivot.

[0025] Thanks to these provisions, when dynamic stresses are applied, the system makes it possible for the module to move in translation along the post.

[0026] In some optional embodiments, the attachment means that is free to move in translation comprises an intermediate assembly means, this intermediate assembly means being configured to form a slide channel around at least one part of the post.

[0027] Thanks to these provisions, the intermediate assembly means makes it possible to increase the surface of contact between the post and the attachment means. This strengthens the securing of the module on the post while retaining the translational freedom of the attachment means.

[0028] In some optional embodiments, the attachment means free to move in translation and comprising an intermediate assembly means is free to rotate, and also comprises an intermediate rotational means forming a pivot link or sliding pivot with the intermediate assembly means.

[0029] Thanks to these provisions, the assembly formed of the intermediate assembly means and the intermediate rotational means enables the rotational freedom of the attachment means.

[0030] In some optional embodiments, the photovoltaic module is rectangular, the module being oriented such that a short side of the module is arranged facing a surface on which the photovoltaic system is installed.

[0031] Thanks to these provisions, the photovoltaic module present in the photovoltaic system is secured by at least one of its long sides. In this way resistance to mechanical stresses is improved compared to a system in which a module is secured by one of its short sides. In particular, additional support is provided to the module by securing a long side of the module to the post, enabling its layout in a configuration referred to as “portrait”. A more stable and vertical fixed bifacial photovoltaic system is therefore installed in the ground. The system also makes it possible to reduce the footprint, and in particular to increase compatibility with agricultural activity on the installation land.

[0032] In addition, this system is therefore compatible with, for example, agrivoltaism. Such an installed system also has a low hydrological impact on the plants when it is installed on agricultural land. Therefore, coactivity is established, corresponding to the coexistence between a major agricultural activity and an efficient production of energy by one or more photovoltaic systems. This coactivity is referred to as “agrivoltaism”, also known as “Agri-PV” or “APV”.

[0033] In some optional embodiments, the photovoltaic system also comprises: [0034] at least one cross member arranged under the module positioned facing a surface on which the photovoltaic system is installed, and having extremities; and [0035] at least two fastenings, each such fastening being configured to secure an individual extremity of at least one such cross-member to a post, this cross-member being arranged and secured between at least two posts.

[0036] Thanks to these provisions, the cross-member makes it possible to improve the system's stability and mechanical resistance. Additionally, the cross-member makes it possible in particular, when it is arranged below and in contact with a module, to reinforce the vertical and height maintenance of the module subjected to gravity. Lastly, the cross-member, for example, can enable the routing and protection of the electric cables of the photovoltaic system.

[0037] According to a second aspect, the present invention envisages a method for installing a deformable vertical photovoltaic system comprising: [0038] a step of securing an extremity of at least one post to the ground, each post having an axis; [0039] a step of securing a removable cross-member to at least one post; [0040] a step of positioning at least one photovoltaic module resting on the cross-member, each photovoltaic module having a front face, referred to as the “principal surface” of the module, parallel to the plane formed by the active parts of the photovoltaic cells; [0041] a step of securing a lower part of said module to said at least one post by a lower attachment means that is deformable and/or at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post and/or at least free to rotate on an axis perpendicular to the axis of the post and parallel to the principal surface of the module; [0042] a step of securing an upper part of at least one module to said at least

one post by an upper attachment means that is deformable and/or at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post and/or at least free to rotate on an axis perpendicular to the axis of the post and parallel to the principal surface of the module, at least one attachment means from amongst the lower attachment means and the upper attachment means being deformable and/or at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post, and the other means being deformable and/or at least free to rotate on an axis perpendicular to the axis of the post; and [0043] a step of removing the removable cross-member.

[0044] As the particular aims, advantages and features of the method that is the subject of the present invention are similar to those of the device that is the subject of the present invention, they are not repeated here.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

[0045] Other advantages, aims and particular features of the invention will become apparent from the non-limiting description that follows of at least one particular embodiment of the device and method that are the subjects of the present invention, with reference to drawings included in an appendix, wherein:

[0046] FIG. 1 represents, schematically, in a front view, a first particular embodiment of the photovoltaic system that is the subject of this invention;

[0047] FIG. 2 represents, schematically, in a front view, a variant of the first particular embodiment of the photovoltaic system represented in FIG. 1;

[0048] FIG. 3 represents, schematically, in a front view, a variant of the first particular embodiment of the photovoltaic system represented in FIG. 1;

[0049] FIG. 4 represents, schematically, in a front view, a variant of the first particular embodiment of the photovoltaic system represented in FIG. 1;

[0050] FIG. 5 represents, schematically, in a side view, a static view on the left and a dynamic view on the right of a particular embodiment of the photovoltaic system that is the subject of the present invention;

[0051] FIG. 6 represents, schematically, in a side view, a static view on the left and a dynamic view on the right of a particular embodiment of the photovoltaic system that is the subject of the present invention;

[0052] FIG. 7 represents, schematically, in a side view and in cross-section, a first particular embodiment of a lower attachment means;

[0053] FIG. 8, represents, schematically, in a top view and in cross-section, the lower attachment means represented in FIG. 7;

[0054] FIG. 9 represents, schematically, in a side view and in cross-section, a second particular embodiment of a lower attachment means;

[0055] FIG. 10 represents, schematically, in a top view and in cross-section, three variants of the lower attachment means represented in FIG. 9;

[0056] FIG. 11, represents, schematically, in a top view and in cross-section, a fourth variant of the lower attachment means represented in FIG. 9;

[0057] FIG. 12 represents, schematically and in perspective, a first particular embodiment of an upper attachment means;

[0058] FIG. 13 represents, schematically, in a top view and in cross-section, three variants of the upper attachment means represented in FIG. 12;

[0059] FIG. 14, represents, schematically, in a side view and in cross-section, one of the three variants of the upper attachment means represented in FIG. 13;

[0060] FIG. 15 represents, schematically and in perspective, particular embodiments of elements

comprised in the upper and lower attachment means represented in FIGS. 9 to 14;
[0061] FIG. 16 represents, schematically and in perspective, four particular embodiments of a post;
[0062] FIG. 17 represents, schematically, in a top view and in cross-section, six particular embodiments of a post;
[0063] FIG. 18 represents, schematically, in a top view and in cross-section, four particular embodiments of a post, an upper attachment means, an intermediate attachment means, and an intermediate rotational means;
[0064] FIG. 19 represents, schematically, in a side view and in cross-section, five particular embodiments of a cross-member;
[0065] FIG. 20 represents, schematically, in a side view and in cross-section, three particular embodiments of a cross-member;
[0066] FIG. 21 represents, schematically, in a side view and in cross-section, three particular embodiments of a cross-member; and
[0067] FIG. 22 represents, schematically and in the form of a logic diagram, a particular series of steps of the method that is the subject of the present invention.

DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

[0068] The present description is given in a non-limiting way, in which each characteristic of an embodiment can be combined with any other characteristic of any other embodiment in an advantageous way.

[0069] Throughout the description, the term “upper” or “top” refers to being located at the top in FIGS. 1 to 6, which corresponds to the normal use configuration of the system, and “bottom” or “lower” to being located at the bottom in these FIGS. 1 to 6. The term “back” refers to being located to the rear of the plane of the FIGS. 1 to 4, and “front” to being located at the front of the plane of the FIGS. 1 to 4. The terms “vertical” and “horizontal” flow from these definitions. The term “left” refers to being located on the left in FIGS. 5, 6, 10, 13, 15, 20. The term “right” refers to being located on the right in FIGS. 5, 6, 10, 13, 15, 20. The systems shown in FIGS. 1 to 6 each have an axis A corresponding to an axis of a post when the photovoltaic system is not submitted to dynamic mechanical stresses. When the system is subjected to dynamic mechanical stresses, as shown on the right of FIGS. 5 and 6, the axis A of a post is a tangent to the curve formed by a post deformed under the effect of stresses. The systems shown in FIGS. 1 to 6 also have an axis B parallel to the “principal surface” of the module and perpendicular to the axis A of a post.

[0070] The following definitions are noted here:

[0071] The term “deformable” refers to an elastic deformation of a part or a whole comprising an elastic material, i.e. a material able to undergo deformation when forces are applied, and return to its initial condition with no alterations when these forces are no longer applied. In other words, an elastically deformable material is able to undergo an elastic deformation, unlike a plastically deformable material.

[0072] The term “increased electricity production” refers to an increase in the production of electricity, for example due to a larger amount of solar energy reaching the photovoltaic cells of the module.

[0073] The term “bifacial module” refers to a module producing electricity on both of its faces. The faces of a module are the two surfaces having the largest dimension. A bifacial module allows the light on its front face and its back face to be transmitted to its photovoltaic cells. The photovoltaic cells use the light on both of their faces to produce electricity. In general, there is a junction box on the back face of the module, and the power generated by the back face is usually less than the power generated by the front face.

[0074] The term “facing the ground” refers to an installation configuration in which one short side of the photovoltaic module is closer to the ground than the other short side of the photovoltaic module when the photovoltaic module is rectangular.

[0075] The term “C-shaped”, used to define the shape of a cross-member, refers to a general shape

having: [0076] a support side, which supports an element and is substantially horizontal; [0077] a side opposite the support side, which does not support an element and is substantially horizontal; [0078] the support side and the opposite side being connected by two sides, these two sides corresponding to a front side and a back side, the front side or the back side being at least partially free of material.

[0079] The term “U-shaped”, used to define the shape of a cross-member, refers to a general shape having: [0080] a support side, which supports an element and is substantially horizontal; [0081] a side opposite the support side, which does not support an element and is substantially horizontal and partially free of material; [0082] the support side and the opposite side being connected by two sides, these two sides corresponding to a front side and a back side.

[0083] The term “installation surface” refers to a surface on which a photovoltaic system is installed. For example, such a surface refers to an installation ground. For example, the installation ground of the photovoltaic system is agricultural land.

[0084] The term “dynamic mechanical stresses” refers to stresses exerted on an installed photovoltaic system. In particular, these stresses are dependent on the characteristics of the installation site of the photovoltaic system. For example, such stresses are exerted by the wind applied on the surface of a photovoltaic module. Under the effect of the wind, the module follows, for example, a translational movement, and thus exerts a force on the post. A reversible deformation of the post is therefore observed, as shown on the right of FIGS. 5 and 6. Note that the deformation of the post under the effect of the wind is not linear, in other words, the longitudinal profile of the post deformed under the effect of the wind follows a curve.

[0085] It is now noted that the figures are not to scale.

[0086] FIG. 1, which is not to scale, shows a schematic view of an embodiment of the photovoltaic system **100** that is the subject of the present invention. The photovoltaic system **100** is substantially vertical with respect to the installation ground **102**, and deformable.

[0087] It can be seen that the photovoltaic system **100** comprises at least one photovoltaic module **105** and at least one post **110** having an axis A. Preferably, the photovoltaic system comprises at least two posts **110**. It can be seen that the photovoltaic module **105** of the system **100** has a front face, referred to as the “principal surface” of the module **105**, parallel to the plane formed by the active parts of the photovoltaic cells. In particular, the plane is limited by the outer edges of the frames, or by the front and back layers protecting the modules when the module has no frame. The front and back layers can be made of glass in the case of double-glass modules, it is noted that other materials can also be used. The so-called “front” face of the photovoltaic module **105**, corresponds to a surface having the largest dimension, referred to as “maximum”. The face opposite the front face is referred to as a “back” face, and generally has the same surface as the front face. For example, when the photovoltaic module **105** is a parallelepiped, the maximum surface corresponds to the face delimited by the two edges (width, length or height) of the module having the largest values.

[0088] FIG. 1 shows that the photovoltaic system **100** comprises: [0089] a first attachment means **115**, referred to as the “lower attachment means”, for attaching a lower portion of a module **105** to a post **110**; and [0090] a second attachment means **120**, referred to as the “upper attachment means”, for attaching an upper portion of a module **105** to a post **110**.

[0091] In some embodiments, such as the one shown in FIG. 1, the principal surface, or front face, of a photovoltaic module **105** has the form of a parallelepiped.

[0092] In some embodiments (not shown), at least two photovoltaic modules **105** are arranged vertically, one photovoltaic module **105** being arranged above the other photovoltaic module **105** when the photovoltaic system **100** is installed.

[0093] In some embodiments, the photovoltaic module **105** is framed. In some variants, the photovoltaic module **105** is frameless. In other words, the securing edge of the module **105** has no securing frame. For example, the photovoltaic module **105** is a double-glass module with no frame,

also known as a “photovoltaic laminate” in the photovoltaic industry.

[0094] Note that a post **110** of the photovoltaic system **100** has an axis A, and this axis is parallel to a largest dimension of the post **110** when the system **100** is not subject to any deformation. For example, when the post **110** is a tapered cylinder, the axis A is parallel to a generatrix of the tapered cylinder. For example, when the post **110** is polyhedral, the axis A is parallel to an edge having a largest dimension.

[0095] In some embodiments, such as the one shown in FIG. 1, the posts **110** are substantially vertical relative to the installation ground **102**. In some variants (not shown), the posts **110** are inclined relative to the installation ground **102** and parallel to each other. In other words, the posts **110** are not orthogonal relative to the general plane formed by the installation ground **102**. In this variant, it is noted that the inclination is not linked to the deformation of the photovoltaic system **100** subjected to dynamic mechanical stresses. For example, all the posts are vertical relative to the horizon, but not relative to the ground.

[0096] In some embodiments, such as the one shown in FIG. 1, the lower extremity of a post **110** comprises a block **101**. The block **101** is partially or fully anchored in the ground **102** and thus strengthens the adhesion of the post **110** to the ground **102**. Note that the adhesion and stabilisation of the post **110** on the ground **102** are achieved by any means known to the person skilled in the art. For example, the lower extremity of a post **110** is secured to the block **101** by a set of bolts.

[0097] In some embodiments, such as the one shown in FIG. 1, the lower attachment means **115** is free to rotate on an axis B perpendicular to the axis A of the post **110** and parallel to the principal surface of the module **105**. In these embodiments, the upper attachment means **120** is free to move in translation along the axis A of the post **110**. Preferably, the upper attachment means **120** is also free to rotate on an axis C. FIGS. 7 and 8 show an embodiment of a lower attachment means **115** that is free to rotate. The rotational freedom of the lower attachment means **115** is indicated, in FIG. 7, by a semicircular double-headed arrow.

[0098] In some embodiments, such as the one shown in FIGS. 7 and 8, the photovoltaic module **105** is secured to the lower attachment means **115** by a bolt comprising a screw **121** and a nut **123**. In some variants, the lower attachment means **115** is rigidly attached to the module **105** by at least one clip system **129** as shown in FIG. 11, a spring and/or a clamp.

[0099] In some embodiments, such as the one shown in FIGS. 7 and 8, the element **119** of the lower attachment means **115** is parallelepipedal. The element **119** is in contact with the lower portion of the module **105**. In particular, the element **119** is in contact with a back surface, or back face, of the module **105**. Note that the element **119** comprises a hole into which a shaft **118** is inserted. The axis of the shaft **118** is the axis B and is perpendicular to the axis A of the post **110**. Preferably, the shaft **118** is held in the hole of the element **119** by a nut **122**, as can be seen in FIG. 8. Note that the hole of the element **119** and the shaft **118** form a pivot link. In particular, this pivot link follows a movement that is similar to a pendulum movement as shown by the double-headed arrow in FIG. 7. In some variants, the hole of the element **119** and the shaft **118** form a sliding pivot link.

[0100] FIG. 8 shows that the lower attachment means **115** comprises a slide **116**. Preferably, the part **116** is a tapered cylinder. Note that the post **110** comprises a slot **111** forming a slide channel. In these embodiments, during the preliminary rigid attachment of the photovoltaic module **105** to the post **110**, the slide **116** and the slot **111** form a sliding link. In particular, the module **105** is preliminarily attached to the post **110** by a translational movement along the axis A of the post **110**. When the module **105** is preliminarily attached and positioned at a predefined height, the slide **116** is held in place in the slide channel **111** by a nut **117**. The nut **117** is in fixed contact with a surface of the post **110**. The use of the nut **117** corresponds to a complete rigid attachment of the lower portion of the module **105** to the post **110**. In other words, the nut **117** eliminates the translational freedom of the lower attachment means **115** by securing the slide **116** and shaft **118** assembly at a predefined height of the post **110**. In some variants, such as the one shown in FIG. 3, the lower

attachment means **115** comprises a stud **118** inserted into a hole of the post **110**. In these variants, as shown in FIGS. **9** to **11**, the post **110** comprises a hole **124** and the rotationally free lower attachment means **115** comprises a shaft **118**. Note that the hole **124** and the shaft **118** form a pivot link. In some variants, the hole **124** and the shaft **118** form a sliding pivot link. Note that the stud **118** and the shaft form a single element.

[0101] It can be seen, on the left of FIG. **10**, that the stud **118** of the lower attachment means **115** has an axis B of rotation. Preferably, the stud **118** has a cylindrical shape, such as the one shown on the right of FIG. **15**.

[0102] In some variants, such as the one shown in the centre of FIG. **10**, the lower attachment means **115** comprises a spring **125**. The spring **125** is arranged between an element **119** and the surface of the post **110** facing the lower attachment means **115**. The spring is therefore in contact with two surfaces. Note that the spring **125** is configured to push the two surfaces in opposite directions. In particular, the spring **125** pushes elements in contact with the post **110** against the post **110**. The spring **125** also pushes elements in contact with the element **119** against the element **119**.

[0103] Therefore, the vibrations linked to a spacing, also called “play”, between different elements are limited. In some variants, the stud **118** has a shoulder in contact with a mobile washer secured to an extremity of the spring **125**. In this variant, the other extremity is secured to the element **119**. The shoulder ensures that the mobile washer is held, and thus prevents the spring from falling when the module **105** is secured to the post **110**.

[0104] In some variants, such as the one shown on the right of FIG. **10**, the stud **118** can be retracted in the element **119** of the lower attachment element **115** by means of a spring **126**. In other words, the spring **126** holds the stud **118** in the hole **124** of the post **110**. The retractability of the stud **118** ensures that the module **105** can be secured rapidly to the post **110**, thereby facilitating the installation of the system **100**.

[0105] FIG. **12** shows an embodiment of an upper attachment means **120** that is free to move in translation along the axis A of the post **110**. The translational freedom of the upper attachment means **120** is indicated, in FIGS. **12** and **14**, by a vertical straight double-headed arrow. The upper attachment means **120** is also free to rotate on an axis C perpendicular to the axis A of the post **110** and parallel to the principal surface of the module **105**. The rotational freedom of the upper attachment means **120** is indicated, in FIG. **12**, by a semicircular double-headed arrow.

[0106] Note that the above description of elements in FIG. **10** also applies to similarly numbered elements shown in FIG. **13**, unless otherwise indicated.

[0107] FIG. **13** shows that the upper attachment means **120** comprises a slide **116**. Preferably, the part **116** is a tapered cylinder, as shown in FIG. **15**. When the slide **116** is a tapered cylinder, the friction present during the sliding of the slide **116** in the slide channel **111** is limited. Note that the post **110** comprises a slot **111** forming a slide channel. In these embodiments, the slide **116** of the upper attachment means **120** and the slide channel **111** of the post **110** form a sliding link. In some variants, the slide **116** of the upper attachment means **120** and the slide channel **111** of the post **110** form a sliding pivot link. Note that the degree of translational freedom of the attachment means **120** is maintained.

[0108] It can be seen, on the left of FIG. **13**, that no element is arranged between an element **119** of the upper attachment means **120** and the surface of the post **110** facing the lower attachment means **120**. In some variants, such as the one shown in the centre of FIG. **13**, a nut **117** is arranged between the element **119** and the surface of the post **110**. In these variants, the nut **117** is not in fixed contact with the surface of the post **110** so as to not eliminate the translational freedom of the upper attachment means **120**. The nut **117** comprised in the upper attachment means **120** prevents the element **119** from rubbing on the surface of the post **110**.

[0109] In other variants, such as the one shown on the right of FIG. **13** and in FIG. **14**, the upper attachment means **120** comprises a spring **125** and a part **127**. The part **127** is arranged between the

spring **125** and the surface of the post **110** facing the upper attachment means **120**. The spring **125** is arranged between the part **127** and an element **119**. The spring is therefore in contact with two surfaces.

[0110] Note that the spring **125**, shown in FIG. **14** and on the right of FIG. **13**, is configured to push the two surfaces in opposite directions. Such a double repulsion is indicated by a horizontal straight double-headed arrow in FIG. **14**. In particular, the spring **125** pushes the part in contact with the post **110** against the post **110**, without limiting the sliding link. In other words, when the upper attachment means **120** follows a translational movement along the axis A of the post, a surface of the element **127** slides over a surface of the post **110**. In addition, the spring **125** also pushes elements, such as the nut **122** shown in FIG. **14**, in contact with the element **119** against the element **119**. Therefore, the vibrations linked to a spacing, also called “play”, between different elements are limited.

[0111] In some embodiments (not shown), the upper attachment means **120** is free to rotate on an axis C perpendicular to the axis A of the post **110** and parallel to the principal surface of the module **105**. In these embodiments, the lower attachment means **115** is free to move in translation along the axis A of the post **110**. Preferably, the lower attachment means **115** is also free to rotate on an axis B.

[0112] Note that the characteristics mentioned for the lower attachment means **115**, in the description above and below, are also applicable to the upper attachment means **120** and vice versa.

[0113] In some variants (not shown), the lower and upper attachment means, **115** and **120**, are elastically deformable and configured to hold a flat principal surface of the photovoltaic module **105** without deformation when the system is subjected to dynamic stresses.

[0114] It is noted that, when the photovoltaic system **100** is installed on a site **102** exposed to strong winds, such a photovoltaic system is deformed elastically. In particular, the post **110** of the system **100** is deformed elastically and in a non-linear deformation, as shown on the right of FIGS. **5** and **6**.

[0115] A non-deformed post **110** of a system **100** is shown on the left of FIGS. **5** and **6**, and an elastically deformed post **110** on the right of FIGS. **5** and **6**. The deformation of the post **110** is achieved in particular by a force exerted on the principal surface of the module **105**. Such a force is, for example, applied by the wind on an outdoors installation site **102**. In FIGS. **5** and **6**, the wind is indicated by three horizontal dashed arrows. In these conditions, dynamic mechanical stresses are applied to the system **100**.

[0116] In some embodiments, such as the one shown in FIG. **5**, the lower attachment means **115** is free to rotate on an axis B perpendicular to the axis A of the post **110** and parallel to the principal surface of the module **105**. In these embodiments, the upper attachment means **120** is free to move in translation along the axis A of the post **110**. Preferably, the upper attachment means **120** is also free to rotate on an axis C. It can be seen that the post **110** shown in FIG. **5** comprises a slot **111**. In some variants, such as the one shown in FIG. **6**, the post **110** comprises an upper slot **111** and a lower hole (not shown).

[0117] For example, when the post **110** is subjected to dynamic mechanical stresses, as shown on the right of FIGS. **5** and **6**, the lower attachment means **115** makes a rotational movement on the axis B. The rotation of the lower attachment means **115** on the axis B is indicated, in FIGS. **5** and **6**, by a lower semicircular double-headed arrow. In addition, the upper attachment means **120** makes a rotational movement on the axis C and a translational movement on the axis A. The rotational movement of the upper attachment means **120** on the axis C is indicated, in FIGS. **5** and **6**, by an upper semicircular double-headed arrow. The translational movement of the upper attachment means **120** on the axis A is indicated, in FIGS. **5** and **6**, by a vertical straight double-headed arrow. Note that the axis A, when the post **110** is deformed, corresponds to a tangent to the arc of deformation formed by the slot **111**. Thus, through the performance and cooperation of these three movements, two rotational and one translational, the surface of the post **105** remains flat.

[0118] In some embodiments, at least one post **110** has a cross-sectional profile, **1101**, **1102**, **1103**, **1104**, **1105**, **1106** or **1107**, with the following shape: [0119] triangle **1104**, as shown in FIGS. **16** to **18**; [0120] rectangle **1103**, as shown in FIGS. **16** to **18**; [0121] symmetrical H **1102**, as shown in FIGS. **16** and **17**; [0122] asymmetrical H **1105**, as shown in FIG. **17**; [0123] inclined H (not shown); [0124] cross **1101**, as shown in FIGS. **16** to **18**; [0125] C **1107**, as shown in FIG. **17**; [0126] F (not shown); [0127] T **1106**, as shown in FIG. **17**; [0128] inclined T (not shown); [0129] offset inclined T (not shown); or [0130] inclined Z (not shown).

[0131] Note that the choice of the cross-sectional profile of the post **110**, from amongst the cross-sectional profiles mentioned above, is made based, for example, on: [0132] the mechanical resistance; [0133] the installation constraints; [0134] minimising production and installation costs; and/or [0135] a reduced vertical shadow behind the module **105** when the module **105** is bifacial. [0136] In this way, the system's ease of installation and mechanical resistance are improved. In addition, the system **100** has a reduced vertical shadow on the back face of the module **105**. When the module **105** is bifacial, the electricity production is therefore increased. In addition, when the post **110** has one of the various cross-sectional profiles mentioned above and is at least partially made of a reflective material, an optimum reflection of the sunlight on the photovoltaic module **105** is achieved. This boosts the increased electricity production. Lastly, when the post **110** has one of these various cross-sectional profiles, the compatibility is improved between the post **110**, the upper and lower attachment means, **115** and **120**, and the module **105**. The attachment means, **115** and **120**, are therefore easier to use.

[0137] In some embodiments, such as the one shown in FIG. **2**, the upper and lower attachment means, **115** and **120**, comprise an intermediate assembly means **128**. For example, the intermediate assembly means **128** is also called a “ring”.

[0138] In these embodiments, the intermediate assembly means **128** comprises a slide channel and the post **110** is a slide. In particular, during the preliminary rigid attachment of the photovoltaic module **105** to the post **110**, the post **110** and the intermediate assembly means **128** form a sliding link. In other words, the slide channel of the intermediate assembly means **128** and the slide formed by the post **110** form a sliding link.

[0139] In these embodiments, the module **105** is preliminarily attached to the post **110** by means of the lower attachment means **115** by a translational movement of the assembly means **128**. Such a movement is made on the axis A of the post **110**. Note that the assembly means **128** comprises a slide channel **111** and a part **116** of the post **110** forms a slide. When the module **105** is preliminarily attached and positioned at a predefined height, the assembly means **128** is held in place on the post **110**. In these embodiments, a surface of the assembly means **128** is in fixed contact with a surface of the post **110**. Such a fixed contact corresponds to a complete rigid attachment of the lower portion of the module **105** to the post **110**. In other words, the fixed contact eliminates the translational freedom of the lower attachment means **115** by securing the assembly means **128** at a predefined height of the post **110**. For example, the assembly means **128** is held by: [0140] a bolt **131** passing through the assembly means **128** and the post **110**, comprising respectively a hole, as shown on the right of FIG. **18**; or [0141] a bolt **131** passing through only the assembly means **128** comprising a hole, the extremity of the screw of the bolt **131** in contact with the post **110** therefore compresses the post **110**. Therefore, the holding of the assembly means **128** is independent of the position of any holes of the post **110**.

[0142] In these embodiments, the upper attachment means **120** is free to move in translation and comprises an intermediate assembly means **128**. In particular, three non-limiting variants of such an intermediate assembly means **128** of the upper attachment means **120** are shown in FIG. **18**. The intermediate assembly means **128** is configured to form a slide channel **111** around at least one part **116** of the post **110**. Note that the part **116** of the post forms a slide. In other words, the slide channel **111** of the intermediate assembly means **128** and the slide **116** of the post **110** form a sliding link. In some embodiments, such as those shown in FIGS. **2** and **18**, the upper attachment

means **120** is also free to rotate. In particular, the upper attachment means **120** comprises the intermediate assembly means **128** and an intermediate rotational means **119**. The intermediate assembly means **128** comprises a hole and the intermediate rotational means **119** comprises a shaft **118**. Note that the hole of the intermediate assembly means **128** and the shaft **118** form a pivot link. In other words, the intermediate rotational means **119** forms a pivot link with the intermediate assembly means **128**. In some variants, the intermediate rotational means **119** forms a sliding pivot link with the intermediate assembly means **128**.

[0143] In some variants, such as those shown in FIG. 3, the photovoltaic system **100** comprises:

[0144] a lower attachment means **115** that is free to rotate; and [0145] an upper attachment means **120** that is free to move in translation and in rotation, comprising an intermediate assembly means **128**. The three examples of such an intermediate assembly means **128**, shown in FIG. 18, are also applicable to these variants. Note that the attachment means **120** also comprises an intermediate rotational means **119**.

[0146] In some embodiments, when the installation site has a flat surface, the same intermediate securing means **128** of an attachment means, **115** and/or **120**, is used for securing two photovoltaic modules **105** to the post **110**. In other words, each photovoltaic module **105** is secured to a surface of the post **110**, the two attachment surfaces being different.

[0147] In some embodiments, the lower attachment means **115** and upper attachment means **120** have variable dimensions. These dimensions are determined as a function of the desired distance between the post **110** and the module **105**. Note that the increase in such a spacing distance reduces the shadow cast by the post **110** on the module **105**, especially on the back face. Such a spacing is, for example, utilised when a frameless bifacial photovoltaic module **105** is used in the system **100**. Thus, reducing the shadows cast on the principal surface of the photovoltaic module **105** boosts the increased electricity production.

[0148] In some embodiments, the principal surface, or front face, of the photovoltaic module **105** of the system **100** is aligned to the front surface delimited by a post **110**. In other words, the principal surface of the photovoltaic module **105** is not set back with respect to the front surface delimited by a post **110**. Preferably, the position of the lower and upper attachment means minimise the shadows on the front face.

[0149] In these embodiments, the exposure of the front face of the photovoltaic module **105** to the light rays is increased since the shadows are reduced. Note that, when the photovoltaic module **105** is bifacial, this preferred exposure of the front face results in larger shadows cast on the back face. However, the efficiency of the conversion of solar energy into electrical energy is higher for the front face of the module **105** compared to the back face of the module **105**. Therefore, despite the presence of shadows on the back face of the module **105**, the increased electricity production is boosted by this preferred exposure to light rays of the front face of the module **105**.

[0150] Note that, when the front face of the module is preferably exposed to the light rays, such a solution is less demanding with respect to bifaciality. In other words, the positioning of the photovoltaic module **105** is not dependent on the bifaciality. Therefore, a wider choice of photovoltaic modules **105** is available, including in particular photovoltaic modules **105** with a smaller economic cost.

[0151] When several photovoltaic systems **100** with rows of modules **105** are used, the front faces of the modules **105** can be oriented according to a performance choice for the system. For example, the front faces of the modules **105** are oriented due East through to an orientation due West.

Therefore there is a significant degree of freedom in the orientations of the rows of modules **105**.

Thus a range of electrical profiles is available according to the orientation of the photovoltaic systems and according to the choice of the surface of the posts **110** to be aligned to the front face of the module **105**. In particular, such a flexibility of orientation is utilised, for example, to: [0152]

adjust the system **100** to the spatial constraints inherent in the installation site; and/or [0153]

position the system **100** so as to reduce exposure to strong prevailing winds.

[0154] In some variants, when the installation site is agricultural land, the flexibility of orientation is utilised for installing, for example, rows in a straight line from South to North. This installation is preferably carried out so that the ground receives a uniform amount of light.

[0155] In some embodiments, such as those shown in FIGS. **1** to **6**, the photovoltaic module **105** of the photovoltaic system, **100**, **200**, **300** or **400**, is rectangular. In particular, the photovoltaic module **105** is oriented such that a short side of the module **105** is arranged facing a surface **102** on which the photovoltaic system is installed. In other words, the module **105** is oriented in “portrait” mode as opposed to “landscape” mode. Note that the surface **102** is delimited by the installation ground of the photovoltaic system, **100**, **200**, **300** or **400**.

[0156] In some embodiments, such as the one shown in FIG. **4**, the system **100** also comprises:

[0157] at least one cross-member **401**; and [0158] at least two fastenings **402** of the cross-member.

[0159] In these embodiments, the cross-member **401** is arranged under the module **105**. In this configuration, the photovoltaic system **400** is installed on a surface **102** and the module is positioned opposite a surface **102**. The cross-member **401** has extremities, and each fastening **402** is configured to secure an individual extremity of the cross-member **401** to a post **110**. It is noted that, in FIG. **4**, the cross-member **401** is arranged and secured between at least two posts.

[0160] In these embodiments, when the photovoltaic module **105** is rectangular and has two short sides and two long sides, the short side of the photovoltaic module **105** therefore rests along the cross-member **401**.

[0161] In this way, the risks of the photovoltaic module **105** slipping, in a downward vertical movement, are limited, especially during the installation of the system **100**.

[0162] Several embodiments are possible for the shape of the cross-sectional profile of the cross-member **401** of the system **400** shown in FIG. **4**. These different embodiments are shown in FIGS. **19** and **20**.

[0163] In some embodiments, the cross-member **401** of the system **400** has a cross-sectional profile with the following shape: [0164] C, as shown by the two shapes at the top of FIG. **19**; or [0165] inverted U, as shown by the three shapes in the bottom of FIG. **19**.

[0166] In some embodiments, such as those shown in FIG. **20**, the cross-member **401** also comprises an upper rim in contact with the photovoltaic module **105** and a lower rim configured to hold electrical cables **404** connected to the photovoltaic module **105**. Preferably, the lower rim is a track. It is noted that the lower rim is defined by a width and a height.

[0167] In this way, the electrical cables **404** are protected and oriented according to predefined constraints on use of the photovoltaic system **100**.

[0168] In some embodiments, such as those shown in FIG. **20**, the width of the lower edge of the cross-member **401** shown on the left of FIG. **20** is greater than the widths of the lower edges of the cross-members **401** shown respectively in the centre and on the right of FIG. **20**. It can also be seen that the height of the lower edge of the cross-member **401** shown on the right of FIG. **20** is greater than the heights of the lower edges of the cross-members **401** shown respectively in the centre and on the left of FIG. **20**.

[0169] Preferably, when modules **105** are serially connected, the positive cable of the photovoltaic modules **105** has a different length, shorter or longer, than the length of the negative cable of the photovoltaic modules **105**. Thus, the connectors **403** between the modules **105** are protected by the cross-member **401**. The modules **105** are serially connected in a chain, referred to as a “string”, known to the person skilled in the art. In other words, the positive cable of a first module **105** is connected to a negative cable of a second module **105** by means of a connector **403**. In this configuration, if the positive cable of the first module **105** has a length equal to the length of the negative cable of the second module **105** then the connector **403** of these two cables **404** arrives at the location of the post **110**. Such an arrangement of the connector **403** is to be avoided in certain cases, in particular when the cables are positioned in the bottom of the modules **105**, i.e. at the location of the short side arranged facing the ground **102**. In this case, the connector **403** is not

protected by the cross-member **401**. Therefore, a difference in the length of the positive cable and the negative cable makes it possible to avoid such an arrangement of the connector **403** and thus enables the connector **403** to be protected by the cross-member **401**.

[0170] In some embodiments, not shown, the cross-member **401** comprises at least one hole, or a perforated shape, on the upper rim or on a back rim. It is noted that the back rim of the cross-member **401** is on the same side as the junction box of the photovoltaic module **105**. The hole of the cross-member **401** is configured to facilitate the passage of the electric cables **404** of the photovoltaic module **105**.

[0171] In some embodiments (not shown), a cross-member **401** comprised in the system **100** is configured to at least partially enclose at least one post **110**.

[0172] In this way, the system has a more compact overall structure, thus making it possible to strengthen the stability of the structure.

[0173] For example, the cross-member **401** has slots, longitudinal along an axis parallel to the axes B and C and/or transversal along an axis perpendicular to the axes B and C. Note that such slots are configured to partially or completely enclose a post **110**.

[0174] In some embodiments (not shown), a fastening of the cross-member **401** comprises at least one intermediate fastening configured to complete the enclosure around at least one post **110**. This therefore strengthens the securing of the cross-member to the posts.

[0175] In some variants (not shown), a fastening of the cross-member **401** comprises at least one L-shaped intermediate fastening comprising: [0176] an upper part configured to be secured to a post; and [0177] a lower part, perpendicular to the upper part and to the post, and configured to support the cross-member.

[0178] This strengthens the support of the module **101**, making it possible to limit the mechanical stresses due to gravity.

[0179] In particular, when the system **100**, comprises two posts and two brackets are rigidly attached respectively to a post **110**, the brackets are supports of the extremities of a cross-member **401**. Note that the rigid attachment of a bracket to a post **110** is achieved by any means known to the person skilled in the art. For example, the rigid attachment is achieved by a bolt configured to attach the post **110** with the upper part of the bracket.

[0180] In some embodiments, such as those shown in FIG. **21**, the cross-member **401** is at least partially made of a light-reflecting material and has a C-shaped cross-sectional profile. In FIG. **21**, the light rays are shown by straight arrows. For example, FIG. **21** shows indirect light radiation on the photovoltaic module **105**. The indirect light radiation is the result of the reflection of one or more light rays applied directly on a back surface of the reflective cross-member **401**.

[0181] In some embodiments, such as those shown in FIGS. **1** to **6**, the photovoltaic system **100** comprises no horizontal element connecting two posts **110**, for example a girder, cross-member, brace or strut, arranged above a portion of the module **105** not facing an installation ground. In other words, no horizontal element connecting two parallel posts **110** is arranged above a portion of the module **105** farthest from the ground. For example when the module is rectangular, the system **100** does not comprise any horizontal element connecting two posts arranged above the short side of the module **105** that does not face an installation ground. In other words, no horizontal element connecting two parallel posts **110** is arranged above the short side of the module **105** farthest from the ground.

[0182] FIG. **22** shows a schematic view of an optional embodiment of the method **500** that is the subject of the present invention. The method **500** for installing a deformable vertical photovoltaic system comprises: [0183] a step **501** of securing an extremity of at least one post to the ground; [0184] a step **502** of securing a removable cross-member to said post; [0185] a step **503** of positioning at least one photovoltaic module resting on the cross-member; [0186] a step **504** of securing a lower part of the module to the post by a lower attachment means; [0187] a step **505** of securing an upper part of the module to the post by an upper attachment means; and [0188] a step

506 of removing the removable cross-member.

[0189] In particular, each post has an axis, and each photovoltaic module has a front face, referred to as the “principal surface” of the module, parallel to the plane formed by the active parts of the photovoltaic cells. Note that the plane is limited by the outer edges of the frames, or by the front and back layers protecting the modules when the module has no frame. The front and back layers can be made of glass in the case of double-glass modules, it is noted that other materials can also be used.

[0190] Note that each attachment means is deformable and/or at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post and/or at least free to rotate on the axis perpendicular to the axis of the post and parallel to the surface of the module. In addition, at least one attachment means from amongst the lower attachment means and the upper attachment means is deformable and/or at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post, and the other means is deformable and/or at least free to rotate on an axis perpendicular to the axis of the post.

[0191] During the step **501** of securing an extremity of the post to the installation ground, the post is positioned first so as to differentiate between: [0192] an extremity subsequently secured to the ground; and [0193] an upper portion of the post subsequently secured to a photovoltaic module.

[0194] In particular, during the step **501** of securing the post, the post is secured to the ground using any attachment means known to the person skilled in the art.

[0195] During the step **502** of securing a removable cross-member, such a cross-member is secured reversibly to the post.

[0196] During the positioning step **503**, the module is arranged so as to rest on the cross-member. In this way, the cross-member maintains the position of the module during the securing steps, **504** and **505**.

[0197] During the securing steps, **504** and **505**, the module is secured to the post by the upper and lower attachment means. The choice of the nature of the intermediate attachment means is dependent on the rotational and/or translational freedoms needed for these means. In some embodiments, the lower attachment means is free to rotate, and the upper attachment means is at least free to move in translation. Preferably, the upper attachment means is also free to rotate.

[0198] In some variants, a part of one or more attachment means is present on the post. In other words, the post is machined so as to comprise a part of one or more attachment means. In other variants, this part is secured to the post during the installation of the system on the installation site. For example, the part of the attachment means is positioned approximatively and held in the portion of the final assembly post by, in particular, a lower stop and an upper stop.

[0199] In some variants (not shown), the method for installing a deformable vertical photovoltaic system comprises several steps that may possibly be repeated: [0200] a step of securing an extremity of at least two posts to the ground; [0201] a step of securing a removable cross-member to said posts; [0202] a step **503** of positioning at least one photovoltaic module resting on the cross-member; [0203] a step of securing a lower part of the module to said posts by a lower attachment means; [0204] a step of securing an upper part of the module to said posts by an upper attachment means; and [0205] a step of removing the removable cross-member.

[0206] Preferably, the means of the device **100** are configured to implement the steps of the method **500** and their embodiments as described above, and the method **500** and its different embodiments can be implemented by the means of the device **100**.

Claims

1. Deformable vertical photovoltaic system (**100**, **200**, **300**, **400**) comprising at least: a photovoltaic module (**105**) having a front face, referred to as the “principal surface” of the module, parallel to the plane formed by the active parts of the photovoltaic cells; and a post (**110**) having an axis (A), characterised in that the deformable vertical photovoltaic system comprises at least: a first

attachment means (115), referred to as the “lower attachment means”, for attaching a lower portion of a module to a post; and a second attachment means (120), referred to as the “upper attachment means”, for attaching an upper portion of a module to a post, each means being deformable and/or at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post and/or at least free to rotate on an axis (B, C) perpendicular to the axis of the post and parallel to the principal surface of the module, at least one attachment means from amongst the lower attachment means and the upper attachment means being deformable and/or at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post, and the other attachment means being deformable and/or at least free to rotate on the axis perpendicular to the axis of the post and parallel to the principal surface of the module.

2. System (100, 200, 300, 400) according to claim 1, wherein each means (115, 120) is at least free to move in translation along the axis (A) of the post (110) and/or at least free to rotate on the axis (B, C) perpendicular to the axis of the post and parallel to the principal surface of the module (105), at least one attachment means from amongst the lower attachment means (115) and the upper attachment means (120) being at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post and the other attachment means being at least free to rotate on the axis perpendicular to the axis of the post and parallel to the principal surface of the module.

3. System (100, 200, 300, 400) according to claim 1, wherein one of the attachment means (115, 120) from amongst the lower attachment means (115) and the upper attachment means (120) is at least free to rotate on the axis (B, C) perpendicular to the axis (A) of the post (110) and the other attachment means is at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post and at least free to rotate on the axis perpendicular to the axis of the post and parallel to the principal surface of the module.

4. System (100, 200, 300, 400) according to claim 1, wherein one of the elements from amongst a rotationally free attachment means (115, 120) and the post (110) comprises a hole (124) and the other a shaft (118), the hole and the shaft forming a pivot link or a sliding pivot.

5. System (100, 200, 300, 400) according to claim 1, wherein one of the elements from amongst a translationally free attachment means (115, 120) and the post (110) comprises a slide channel (111) and the other a slide (116), the slide channel and the slide forming a sliding link or a sliding pivot.

6. System (100, 200, 300, 400) according to claim 5, wherein the translationally free attachment means (115, 120) comprises an intermediate assembly means (128), this intermediate assembly means being configured to form a slide channel (111) around at least one part (116) of the post (110).

7. System (100, 200, 300, 400) according to claim 6, wherein the translationally free attachment means (115, 120) comprising an intermediate assembly means (128) is free to rotate, and also comprises an intermediate rotational means (119) forming a pivot link or sliding pivot with the intermediate assembly means.

8. Photovoltaic system (100, 200, 300, 400) according to claim 1, wherein the photovoltaic module (105) is rectangular, the module being oriented such that a short side of the module is arranged facing a surface (102) on which the photovoltaic system is installed.

9. Photovoltaic system (400) according to claim 1, which also comprises: at least one cross member (401) arranged under the module (105) positioned facing a surface (102) on which the photovoltaic system is installed, and having extremities; and at least two fastenings (402), each such fastening being configured to secure an individual extremity of at least one such cross-member to a post (110), this cross-member being arranged and secured between at least two posts.

10. Method (500) for installing a deformable vertical photovoltaic system, characterised in that it comprises: a step (501) of securing an extremity of at least one post to the ground, each post having an axis; a step (502) of securing a removable cross-member to at least one post; a step (503) of positioning at least one photovoltaic module resting on the cross-member, each photovoltaic module having a front face, referred to as the “principal surface” of the module, parallel to the plane formed by the active parts of the photovoltaic cells; a step (504) of securing a lower part of

said module to said at least one post by a lower attachment means that is deformable and/or at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post and/or at least free to rotate on an axis perpendicular to the axis of the post and parallel to the principal surface of the module; a step (505) of securing an upper part of at least one module to said at least one post by an upper attachment means that is deformable and/or at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post and/or at least free to rotate on an axis perpendicular to the axis of the post and parallel to the principal surface of the module, at least one attachment means from amongst the lower attachment means and the upper attachment means being deformable and/or at least free to move in translation along the axis of the post, and the other means being deformable and/or at least free to rotate on an axis perpendicular to the axis of the post; and a step (506) of removing the removable cross-member.
